Manel Leiva

Senior Product Designer, Design Systems

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 15 years designing complex B2B products and building and maintaining production design systems.

Co-led the Abax design system across five squads at Abacum, with adoption tracked monthly, then built Remuner's system from scratch as its sole designer.

Case study: manel-leiva.com/cases/design-systems

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Owned product design across Remuner's sales-compensation platform as its sole designer. Scope spanned data integrations, compensation plans and payouts, rep and manager experiences, and approval workflows.
- Built the component library and design system from scratch, starting with a deliberately small token set, and added ESLint rules that enforced use of system components.
- Ran an ongoing product audit with front-end engineers: each UI pattern got defined variants and states, a ticket, and a decision to fix it now or fold it into an upcoming feature.
- Owned the design side of the token pipeline; used Codex to add CI validation, drift detection, and smoke tests through engineering-reviewed PRs.
- Used the Figma MCP with an AI agent to manage tokens and sync them with code, run accessibility checks, work with components and write documentation.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Designed workflows across Abacum's data-integration and financial-modeling areas, first in the Integrations squad and later Engine. Work spanned integrations, datasets, dimensions and mappings, models, and the modeling language.
- Co-led the Abax design-system business case with the head of design and presented it to engineering leadership; the work was selected for dedicated design and engineering time.
- Moved squads from MUI to Abax: new components shipped behind feature flags and squads added their own migration tickets. A monthly codebase count put Abax at about 47% of tracked component uses at departure.
- Ran the weekly design-library sync and contribution process; components moved from exploration into the canonical library only after review.
- Worked on Abax's two-tier token architecture and its Token Studio to Style Dictionary pipeline.

Co-founder, UX Design Lead

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, on-site

- Co-founded and led a UX studio for 11 years; designed products for media, retail, finance, legal, and culture clients.
- Built CMS-connected front ends, reusable component libraries, and a shared starter kit with a build pipeline and CSS variables.
- Mentored junior practitioners and taught UX, components, and digital design.

SKILLS

Design systems: Token architecture, Figma variables and libraries, component states and variants, documentation, contribution and governance models, adoption tracking, migration planning

Design to code and AI: Storybook, Token Studio, Style Dictionary, GitHub, ESLint, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Codex, Figma MCP with Claude (component variants, colour scales, core and semantic token export)

Product design and research: Complex B2B workflows, interaction design, customer interviews, structured user testing

Languages: Catalan and Spanish (native), English (fluent, C1)

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002